

10. Preposition

Definition and Introduction

A preposition is a word placed before a noun or pronoun to show its relation with another word in a sentence. It usually shows position, time, direction, or movement. Prepositions help us understand how different parts of a sentence are connected. They are always followed by an object. Correct use of prepositions is important for grammatical accuracy.

The book is on the table.

She sat under the tree.

He came after lunch.

The cat is between the chairs.

We walked through the park.

Preposition Rules

Prepositions are always followed by a noun or pronoun called the object. They are not used alone in a sentence. Different prepositions are used in different contexts. Sometimes the choice of preposition depends on usage rather than logic. Learning common combinations helps avoid mistakes.

She is fond of music.

He is afraid of dogs.

We depend on our parents.

She is good at maths.

They are interested in sports.

Adverb Preposition

Some words can act as both adverbs and prepositions depending on their use. When such a word has an object, it is a preposition. Without an object, it acts as an adverb. Understanding the difference helps in correct identification. Context decides the function of the word.

He went in. (adverb)

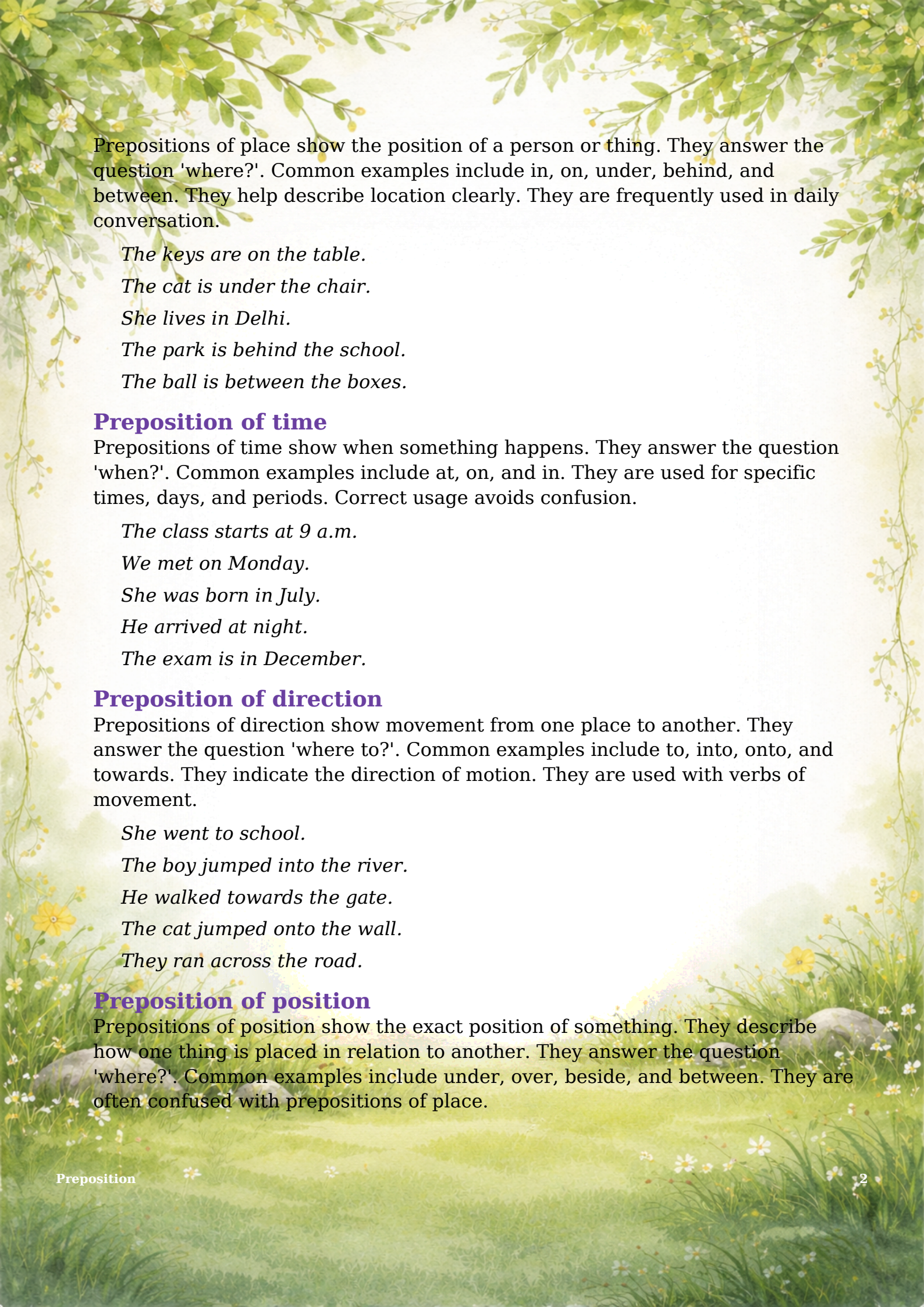
He went in the room. (preposition)

She looked up. (adverb)

She looked up the word. (preposition)

The dog ran out. (adverb)

Preposition of place



Prepositions of place show the position of a person or thing. They answer the question 'where?'. Common examples include in, on, under, behind, and between. They help describe location clearly. They are frequently used in daily conversation.

The keys are on the table.

The cat is under the chair.

She lives in Delhi.

The park is behind the school.

The ball is between the boxes.

Preposition of time

Prepositions of time show when something happens. They answer the question 'when?'. Common examples include at, on, and in. They are used for specific times, days, and periods. Correct usage avoids confusion.

The class starts at 9 a.m.

We met on Monday.

She was born in July.

He arrived at night.

The exam is in December.

Preposition of direction

Prepositions of direction show movement from one place to another. They answer the question 'where to?'. Common examples include to, into, onto, and towards. They indicate the direction of motion. They are used with verbs of movement.

She went to school.

The boy jumped into the river.

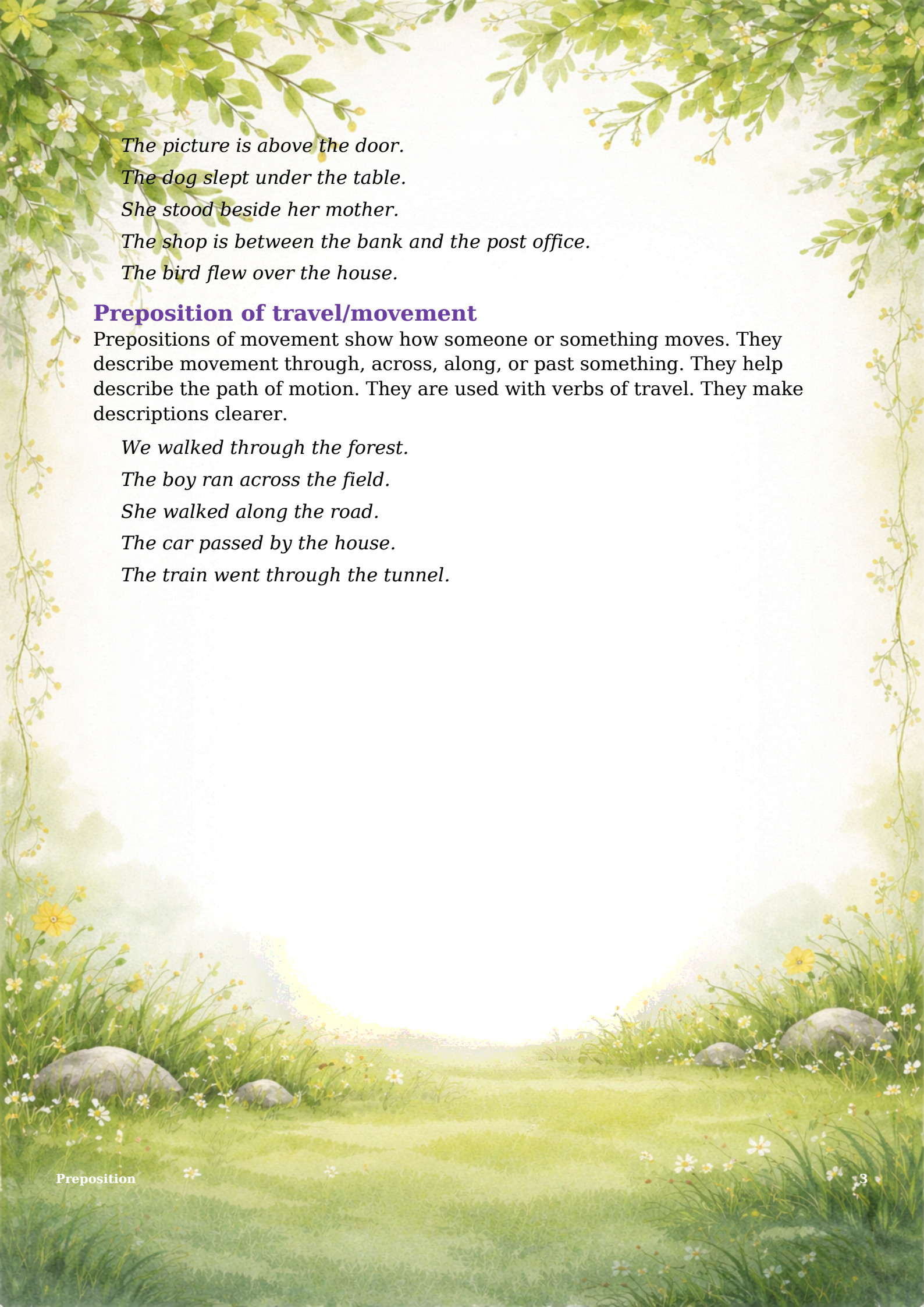
He walked towards the gate.

The cat jumped onto the wall.

They ran across the road.

Preposition of position

Prepositions of position show the exact position of something. They describe how one thing is placed in relation to another. They answer the question 'where?'. Common examples include under, over, beside, and between. They are often confused with prepositions of place.

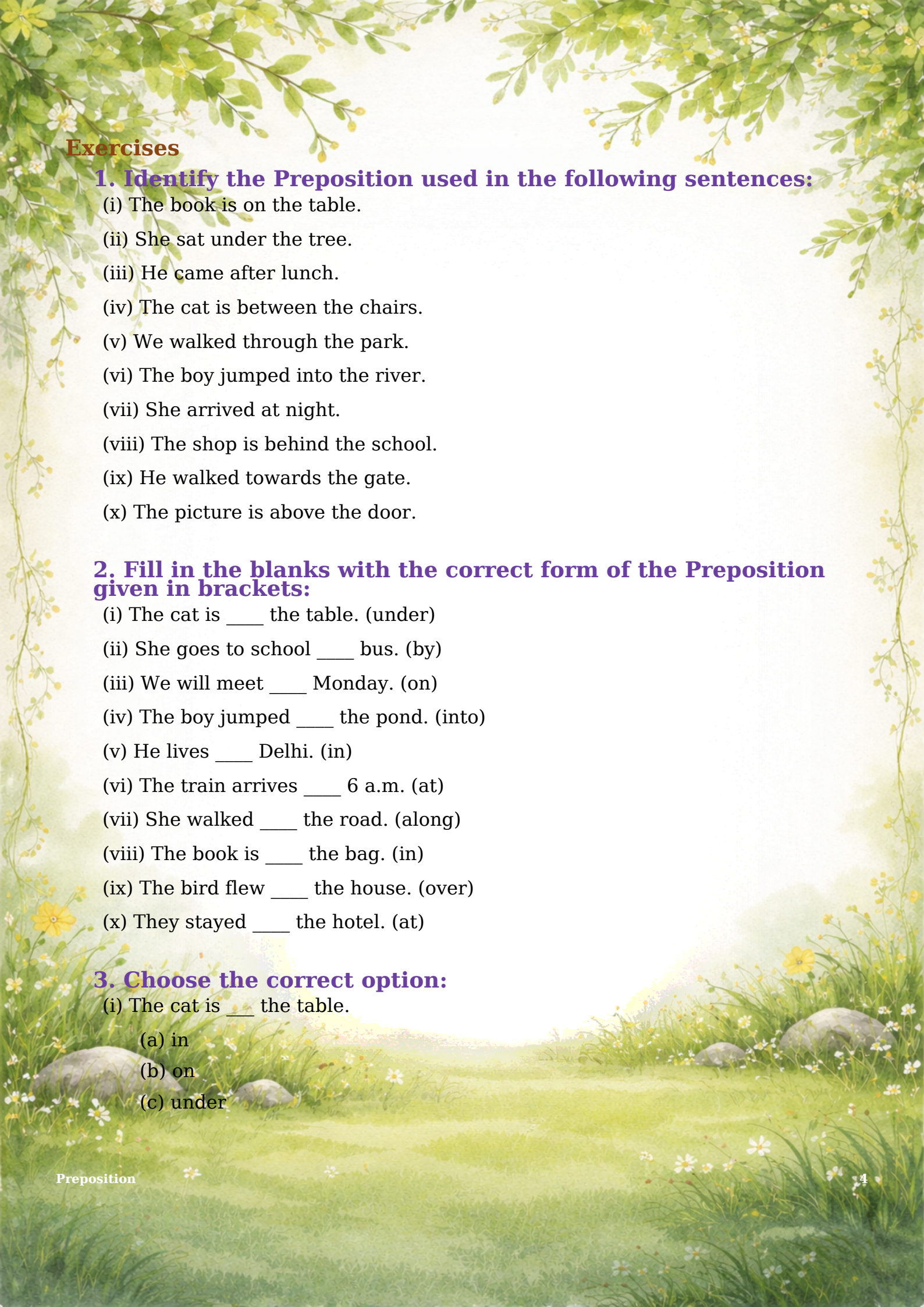


*The picture is above the door.
The dog slept under the table.
She stood beside her mother.
The shop is between the bank and the post office.
The bird flew over the house.*

Preposition of travel/movement

Prepositions of movement show how someone or something moves. They describe movement through, across, along, or past something. They help describe the path of motion. They are used with verbs of travel. They make descriptions clearer.

*We walked through the forest.
The boy ran across the field.
She walked along the road.
The car passed by the house.
The train went through the tunnel.*



Exercises

1. Identify the Preposition used in the following sentences:

- (i) The book is on the table.
- (ii) She sat under the tree.
- (iii) He came after lunch.
- (iv) The cat is between the chairs.
- (v) We walked through the park.
- (vi) The boy jumped into the river.
- (vii) She arrived at night.
- (viii) The shop is behind the school.
- (ix) He walked towards the gate.
- (x) The picture is above the door.

2. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the Preposition given in brackets:

- (i) The cat is ____ the table. (under)
- (ii) She goes to school ____ bus. (by)
- (iii) We will meet ____ Monday. (on)
- (iv) The boy jumped ____ the pond. (into)
- (v) He lives ____ Delhi. (in)
- (vi) The train arrives ____ 6 a.m. (at)
- (vii) She walked ____ the road. (along)
- (viii) The book is ____ the bag. (in)
- (ix) The bird flew ____ the house. (over)
- (x) They stayed ____ the hotel. (at)

3. Choose the correct option:

- (i) The cat is ____ the table.
 - (a) in
 - (b) on
 - (c) under

- 
- (d) at
- (ii) She was born ____ July.
- (a) on
- (b) at
- (c) in
- (d) by
- (iii) He goes to school ____ bus.
- (a) by
- (b) with
- (c) on
- (d) in
- (iv) The boy jumped ____ the river.
- (a) to
- (b) into
- (c) on
- (d) at
- (v) We met ____ Sunday.
- (a) in
- (b) at
- (c) on
- (d) by
- (vi) The picture is ____ the wall.
- (a) in
- (b) on
- (c) at
- (d) by
- (vii) She sat ____ her friend.
- (a) between
- (b) on
- (c) at
- (d) in
- (viii) The train went ____ the tunnel.

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- (a) through
 - (b) over
 - (c) at
 - (d) on

4. Match the following:

List A

- 1. on
- 2. at
- 3. in
- 4. under
- 5. between

List B

- A. a point of time
- B. a surface
- C. a period
- D. below
- E. in the middle of two

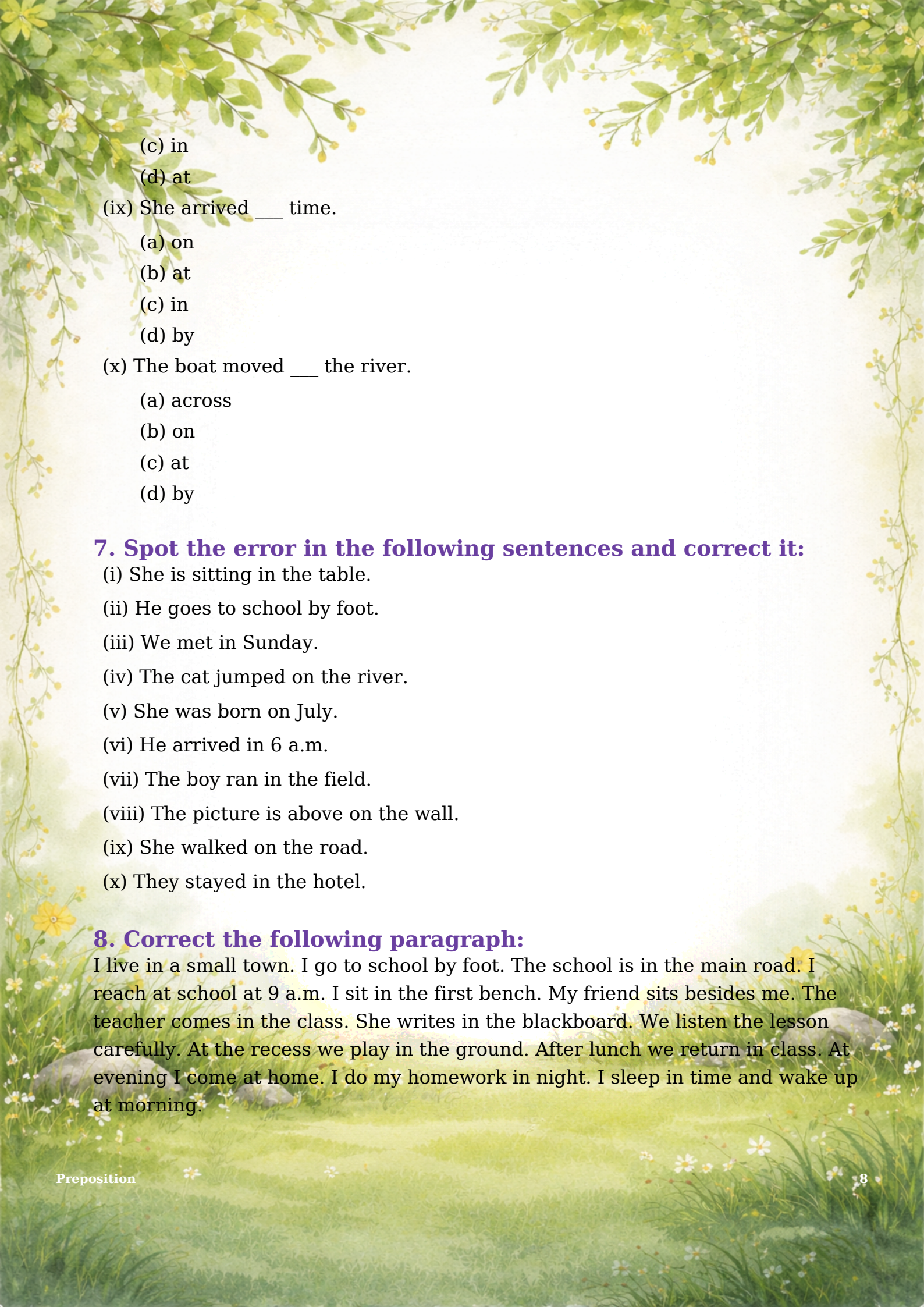
5. Identify the type of Preposition used:

- (i) She lives in Delhi.
- (ii) We met at night.
- (iii) The cat is under the chair.
- (iv) He walked towards the gate.
- (v) The train passed through the tunnel.
- (vi) The book is on the table.
- (vii) She was born in June.
- (viii) The boy ran across the field.
- (ix) The shop is between the bank and the post office.
- (x) He went to school.

6. Multiple choice questions:

- (i) We will meet ____ the evening.
 - (a) at
 - (b) in
 - (c) on
 - (d) by
- (ii) The boy jumped ____ the wall.

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- (a) over
(b) in
(c) at
(d) by
- (iii) She sat ____ me.
(a) beside
(b) in
(c) at
(d) by
- (iv) The train arrives ____ 7 a.m.
(a) at
(b) on
(c) in
(d) by
- (v) The cat hid ____ the bed.
(a) under
(b) on
(c) in
(d) by
- (vi) We walked ____ the road.
(a) along
(b) on
(c) at
(d) by
- (vii) The bird flew ____ the tree.
(a) over
(b) in
(c) at
(d) by
- (viii) He stood ____ his friend.
(a) beside
(b) on

- 
- (c) in
(d) at
- (ix) She arrived ____ time.
(a) on
(b) at
(c) in
(d) by
- (x) The boat moved ____ the river.
(a) across
(b) on
(c) at
(d) by

7. Spot the error in the following sentences and correct it:

- (i) She is sitting in the table.
(ii) He goes to school by foot.
(iii) We met in Sunday.
(iv) The cat jumped on the river.
(v) She was born on July.
(vi) He arrived in 6 a.m.
(vii) The boy ran in the field.
(viii) The picture is above on the wall.
(ix) She walked on the road.
(x) They stayed in the hotel.

8. Correct the following paragraph:

I live in a small town. I go to school by foot. The school is in the main road. I reach at school at 9 a.m. I sit in the first bench. My friend sits besides me. The teacher comes in the class. She writes in the blackboard. We listen the lesson carefully. At the recess we play in the ground. After lunch we return in class. At evening I come at home. I do my homework in night. I sleep in time and wake up at morning.



Answer Sheet

1. Identify the Preposition:

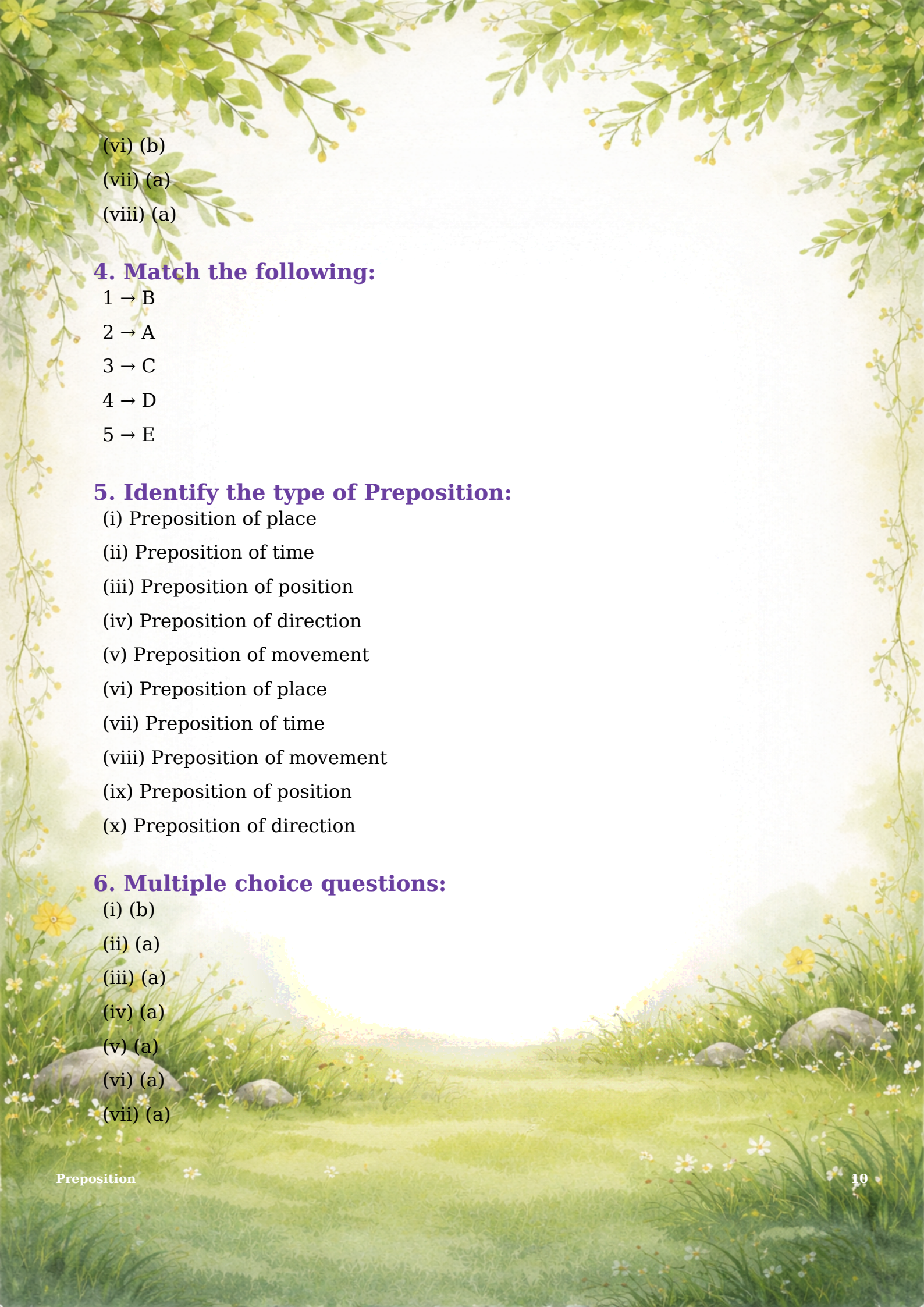
- (i) on
- (ii) under
- (iii) after
- (iv) between
- (v) through
- (vi) into
- (vii) at
- (viii) behind
- (ix) towards
- (x) above

2. Fill in the blanks:

- (i) under
- (ii) by
- (iii) on
- (iv) into
- (v) in
- (vi) at
- (vii) along
- (viii) in
- (ix) over
- (x) at

3. Choose the correct option:

- (i) (c)
- (ii) (c)
- (iii) (a)
- (iv) (b)
- (v) (c)



(vi) (b)

(vii) (a)

(viii) (a)

4. Match the following:

1 → B

2 → A

3 → C

4 → D

5 → E

5. Identify the type of Preposition:

(i) Preposition of place

(ii) Preposition of time

(iii) Preposition of position

(iv) Preposition of direction

(v) Preposition of movement

(vi) Preposition of place

(vii) Preposition of time

(viii) Preposition of movement

(ix) Preposition of position

(x) Preposition of direction

6. Multiple choice questions:

(i) (b)

(ii) (a)

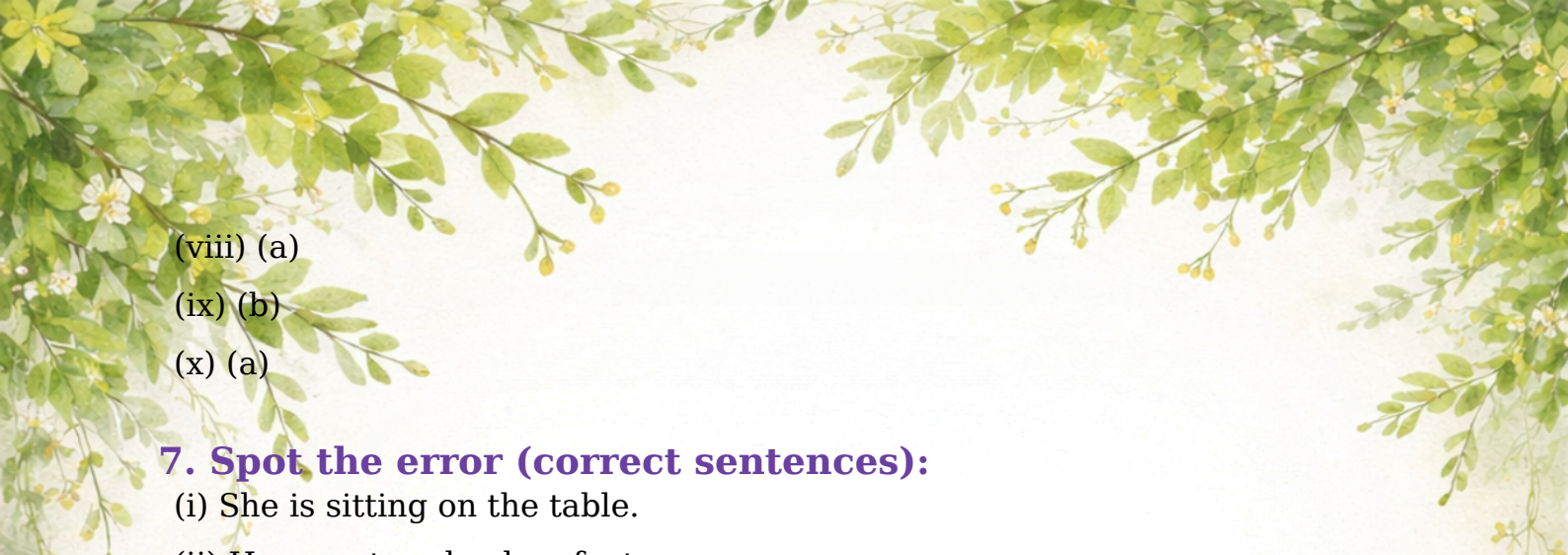
(iii) (a)

(iv) (a)

(v) (a)

(vi) (a)

(vii) (a)



(viii) (a)

(ix) (b)

(x) (a)

7. Spot the error (correct sentences):

- (i) She is sitting on the table.
- (ii) He goes to school on foot.
- (iii) We met on Sunday.
- (iv) The cat jumped into the river.
- (v) She was born in July.
- (vi) He arrived at 6 a.m.
- (vii) The boy ran across the field.
- (viii) The picture is on the wall.
- (ix) She walked along the road.
- (x) They stayed at the hotel.

8. Corrected paragraph:

I live in a small town. I go to school on foot. The school is on the main road. I reach school at 9 a.m. I sit on the first bench. My friend sits beside me. The teacher comes into the class. She writes on the blackboard. We listen to the lesson carefully. At recess we play in the ground. After lunch we return to class. In the evening I come home. I do my homework at night. I sleep on time and wake up in the morning.